The addition of nutmeg to this recipe gives the soup a wonderfully distinctive flavor. Be generous with the nutmeg for the best, and tastiest, results.

butternut squash soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 25 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
WITHOUT THE CREAM

1½ tbsp butter
1lb 2oz (500g) butternut squash, seeded and chopped into 1in (2.5cm) pieces
1 medium onion, chopped
1 garlic clove, crushed
a generous grating of nutmeg
2 cups hot chicken stock
½ cup heavy cream or half-and-half
salt and freshly ground black pepper

1 Melt the butter in a heavy-bottomed saucepan. Add the squash, onion, and garlic, cover with a lid, and cook for 15 minutes, stirring occasionally. Grate in the nutmeg and cook with the lid on for another 5 minutes.

2 Stir in the stock and bring to a boil. When the squash is tender, add the cream and simmer for 1 minute. Transfer the soup to a blender and process until smooth. You may need to do this in batches. Season with salt and freshly ground black pepper and serve.